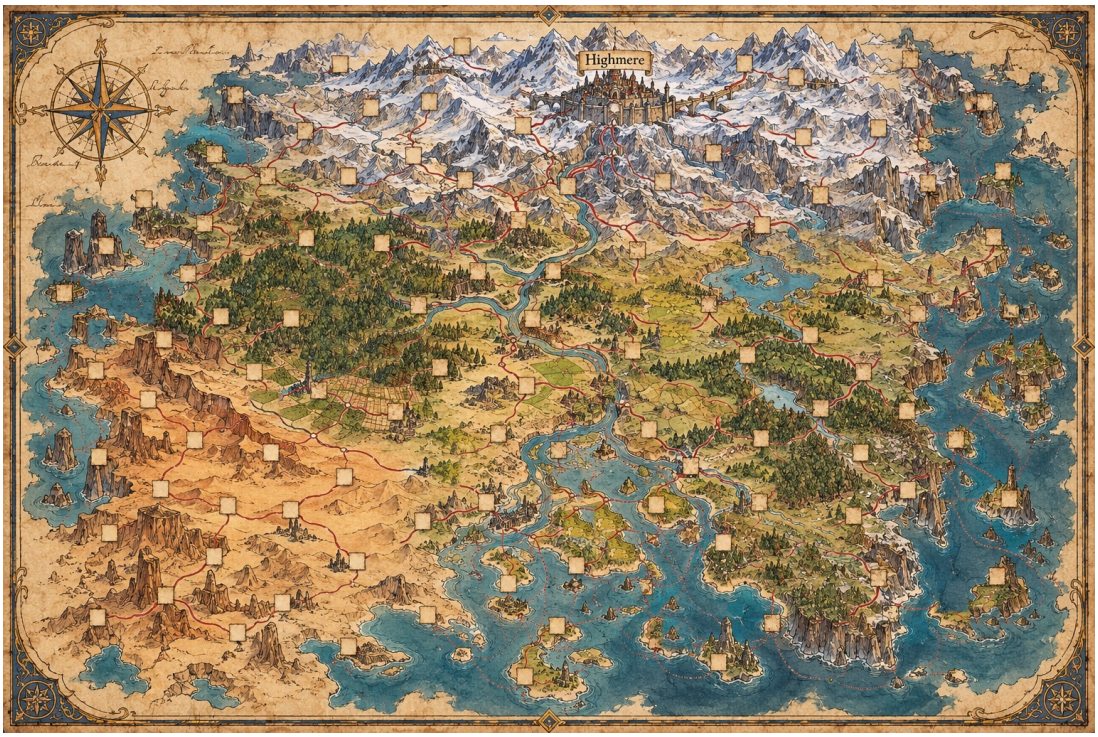
THIS YEAR'S MCC AWARD BOOK

100 Puzzles



The Great Map of Highmere. The pale squares are the hundred places that have fallen silent.

To the young problem-solvers of Math Club & Competitions,

My name is Orla. I keep the Great Map of Highmere: mountains in brown ink, rivers in blue, roads in fine red lines. Travellers plan their journeys by it, healers find their way to the sick by it, and merchants send their wagons along its roads.

But a hundred places on my map have faded to pale squares. They are still there, and people still live in them, but each has fallen silent: a gate that will not open, a lantern that will not light, a trouble nobody there can solve, and slowly the wagons and the letters stopped coming. So four of my apprentices have set out, with a very small dragon and a raven, to help, one place at a time, and to bring each place back onto the map.

They will need company. This winter, the club's award winners will receive the first half of their journey: fifty places, each with its story, its picture and its puzzle, and every answer explained at the back. Some puzzles are gentle; some will keep a strong high-school student busy for an evening. All of them need only careful thinking, a pencil, and the courage to try an idea that might not work.

The road starts at Coldhearth, a day out of Highmere. Bring a warm coat.

Orla
Master of the Great Map, Highmere

FOR PARENTS

A gift for the club's award winners







What it is. *100 Puzzles* is an illustrated book of original story puzzles in mathematics, logic and science, written for MCC. Each puzzle is a short story with its own picture, a clear list of what is allowed, and two or three questions that climb in difficulty. Hints and complete solutions, written for students, are at the back.

Who it is for. Students from about Grade 6 upwards, with puzzles that also stretch high-school students. Each puzzle is marked *Explorer*, *Investigator* or *Master*, so every reader finds their level. Any science a puzzle needs is explained inside it.

One story. The hundred puzzles are one journey across a map: four apprentices, a small dragon and a raven bringing silent places back to life. Every puzzle can still be read and solved on its own.

Two volumes. Volume 1 (puzzles 1–50) is given to the club's first-semester award winners in December 2026. Volume 2 (puzzles 51–100) follows.

English or Vietnamese. Each winner chooses English or Vietnamese. Both editions have the same stories, pictures, map and names, so brothers, sisters and friends reading different editions can talk about the same puzzles.

Try it now. A sample, the Prologue and Puzzle 8, *The Swinging Island*, with its hint and full solution, is on the club website in both languages. Families who would like an extra copy of the book can also order one there.